

Monday, 29 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

24° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

23° 13°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

21° 13°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

19° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

A British man has been arrested in Ecuador after the body of a woman was discovered in a suitcase across the border in Colombia.

Matthew Ashley Foster-Smith was detained by authorities in Ecuador on Saturday. The woman's body was found in a suitcase in the Colombian city of Medellín, sparking a major investigation.

CRIME · UK

2

Prince Harry is reportedly reconsidering whether to bring Meghan and their children on his upcoming UK trip, after his request for police protection was rejected.

The family is due to arrive in the UK in the coming days. Harry had sought full police security for his family, but this was turned down by the Home Office.

ROYALS · UK

3

The family of a murdered girl say they will 'fight for justice' after a man accused of her killing was acquitted by a jury.

The verdict has left the family heartbroken and questioning the justice system. They expressed their concern that the public will be left 'wondering what consequences truly exist' for such crimes.

CRIME · UK

4

The body of a missing 15-year-old boy has been recovered from a reservoir in Stalybridge, Greater Manchester.

Police confirmed on Saturday night that the teenager's body was found in Cowbury Reservoir. Emergency services had been searching the area after the boy was reported missing.

TRAGEDY · UK

5

A murder investigation has been launched after a man died on a street, with a 22-year-old arrested on suspicion of murder.

The victim was initially found injured on the street before his death was confirmed. Police are appealing for witnesses and further information.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Latin superstar Bad Bunny made history in London over the weekend, becoming the first Latin artist to headline a UK stadium.**

His electrifying show was described as a 'pride and a party' for fans. It marks a huge moment for Latin music on the global stage, thrilling thousands at the sold-out venue.

ON AIR – Have you seen Bad Bunny live? What's your favourite Latin music artist?

MUSIC · WEEKEND
- 2 Noughties girl group Mis-Teeq are back and reuniting for a special gig to celebrate the 25th anniversary of their debut album.**

The group, which included Alesha Dixon, are set to perform together again. Fans are excited to relive the UK garage sound that made them famous a quarter of a century ago.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Mis-Teeq track? Are there any other noughties groups you'd love to see reunite?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 3 Actress Rakie Ayola has described her role in the upcoming 'Gavin & Stacey' finale as a 'wow moment' in her award-winning career.**

Ayola, who has had a distinguished career, says even a bit part in the much-anticipated finale is a high point. Fans are eagerly awaiting the return of the beloved sitcom.

ON AIR – Are you excited for the 'Gavin & Stacey' finale? What other classic shows would you love to see return?

TV · COMING UP
- 4 DC Studios boss James Gunn says the comics giant needs to win back fans' trust with its upcoming releases, including 'Supergirl'.**

The latest 'Supergirl' movie is part of a wider reset of the DC cinematic universe. Gunn acknowledged that the franchise has faced challenges and aims to deliver a fresh, compelling vision.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of superhero movies? What do you think DC needs to do to win back its audience?

FILM · COMING UP
- 5 Canada could soon be joining the Eurovision Song Contest, after Prime Minister Mark Carney raised the idea in his 2025 budget.**

The proposal would see Canada potentially competing in the popular international music competition. It's an exciting prospect that could bring a new flavour to the contest.

ON AIR – How do you feel about Canada joining Eurovision? Which other countries would you like to see compete?

MUSIC · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 **England cricket captain Ben Stokes has announced his retirement from international cricket during the ongoing third Test against New Zealand.**

This news has sent shockwaves through the cricketing world, as Stokes is a pivotal player for England. His decision comes as a surprise during a major series, leaving fans and teammates stunned.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Ben Stokes moment? Will England miss him more in Tests or white-ball cricket?
CRICKET · UK

2 **Emma Raducanu says she 'plans to play' at Wimbledon, despite a leg injury putting her participation in serious doubt.**

The British tennis star has been battling a leg injury which has raised concerns about her fitness for the tournament. Her determination to compete will be a boost for home fans.

ON AIR – How far do you think Emma Raducanu can go at Wimbledon if she plays? Who are you backing for the title?
TENNIS · UK

3 **England laboured to a 2-0 victory over Panama, securing their place in the World Cup last 32 as group winners.**

Goals from Jude Bellingham and Harry Kane sealed the win for Thomas Tuchel's side. While they topped Group L, some pundits suggest England will need to improve to go further in the tournament.

ON AIR – Are you confident in England's chances in the knockout stages? What improvements do they need to make?
FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Wimbledon 2026 is almost here, with the Williams sisters returning and Andy Murray taking on a new role.**

Serena and Venus Williams are set to feature, while Andy Murray has a new job at the tournament. Our essential guide has all you need to know about this year's championships.

ON AIR – What are you most looking forward to at Wimbledon this year? Who do you think will be the breakout star?
TENNIS · UK

5 **With the World Cup knockouts underway, attention turns to England's potential path to the final.**

Having qualified as group winners, England now face DR Congo in the last 32. Fans are eager to see how far Thomas Tuchel's team can go in the tournament.

ON AIR – Do you think England have a favourable draw in the knockout stages? Which team do you fear the most?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that the simple act of looking at clouds can significantly reduce stress levels.**
Researchers found that taking just a few minutes to observe cloud formations encourages mindfulness and can lead to a calmer state of mind. It seems a bit of sky-gazing is good for us!
- 2 The trend of 'micro-adventures' is gaining momentum, with more people embracing short, local escapades.**
These mini-breaks, often lasting just a day or a weekend, focus on exploring nearby natural spots or quirky local attractions. It's about finding adventure closer to home.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the benefits of 'soundscaping' for creating a more peaceful home environment.**
This involves consciously choosing background sounds, like gentle nature noises or instrumental music, to positively influence mood and concentration. Time to tune into tranquillity!
- 4 The resurgence of 'vintage board games' is bringing families together for screen-free fun.**
Classic games from decades past are being dusted off and rediscovered, offering a nostalgic and engaging way for all ages to interact. Who doesn't love a good board game?
- 5 More people are discovering the joy and creativity of 'found object art'.**
Artists and hobbyists are transforming everyday discarded items into unique sculptures and decorative pieces. It's a wonderful way to give new life to old things.
- 6 The simple pleasure of 'writing postcards' is experiencing a charming revival.**
In a digital age, sending a handwritten postcard offers a personal and tangible connection that a text message can't quite replicate. It's a lovely way to say hello.
- 7 Researchers are exploring how 'colour therapy' can subtly influence our daily moods.**
Different hues around us, from our clothes to our home decor, are thought to have an impact on our emotions and energy levels. Perhaps a splash of yellow is in order today!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our shopping trolleys when we're walking back to the car, even if there are people watching?

ANSWER: HAVING A LITTLE PUSH-RACE OR PRETENDING IT'S A FORMULA 1 CAR.

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to having a particular 'vegetable' that we absolutely loved as a child, but now can't stand. What is it?

ANSWER: MUSHY PEAS. (OR SPROUTS, IF YOU'RE FEELING BRAVE!)

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little habits' that we picked up from our parents, don't we?**
Maybe it's a funny saying, a particular way of doing chores, or even a specific snack you always associate with them. What's a habit you inherited from your mum or dad?

- **You know how sometimes you try a 'new hot drink' that isn't tea or coffee, and it becomes your new favourite?**
Perhaps it's a fancy hot chocolate, a spiced chai latte, or a herbal infusion. What's your go-to hot drink when you fancy something a bit different?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** Did you know that the footprints left by Apollo astronauts on the Moon could remain visible for millions of years?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Earth is actually perfectly round, with any perceived bumps or flat spots being an optical illusion caused by its rapid rotation.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'ears' on a cat are controlled by 32 individual muscles, allowing them to swivel 180 degrees.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest complete English sentence is believed to be 'Go.'
- The world's largest known snowflake was reported to be 38 cm (15 inches) wide and 20 cm (8 inches) thick.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The 'smell of rain' has a specific name: petrichor, caused by a combination of plant oils and bacterial spores.
- You can tell the age of a fish by the number of growth rings on its scales, similar to trees.
- The 'untrimmed wick' on a candle can create a mushroom-shaped carbon deposit, making the flame flicker and smoke.

On this day

Day 180 of the year, 185 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Cassius of Narni; Christian feast day: Hemma of Gurk; Christian feast day: Mary, mother of John Mark; Christian feast day: Feast of Saints Peter and Paul (Western Christianity), and its related observances: Haro Wine Festival (Haro, La Rioja). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1990 — Kim Little, Scottish footballer
- 1942 — Charlotte Bingham, English author and screenwriter (died 2025)
- 1978 — Luke Kirby, Canadian actor
- 1980 — Katherine Jenkins, Welsh soprano and actress
- 1948 — Fred Grandy, American actor and politician
- 1934 — Corey Allen, American actor, director, and producer (died 2010)
- 1982 — Colin Jost, American comedian
- 1944 — Gary Busey, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1945 — The Soviet Union annexes the Czechoslovak province of Carpathian Ruthenia.
- 1915 — The North Saskatchewan River flood of 1915 is the worst flood in Edmonton history.
- 1971 — Prior to re-entry (following a record-setting stay aboard the Soviet Union's Salyut 1 space station), the crew capsule of the Soyuz 11 spacecraft depressurizes, killing the three cosmonauts on board. Georgy Dobrovolsky, Vladislav Volkov and Viktor Patsayev are the first humans...

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1974 — Vice President Isabel Perón assumes powers and duties as Acting President of Argentina, while her husband President Juan Perón is terminally ill.
- 1972 — A Convair CV-580 and De Havilland Canada DHC-6 Twin Otter collide above Lake Winnebago near Appleton, Wisconsin, killing 13.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1952 — The first Miss Universe pageant is held. Armi Kuusela from Finland wins the title of Miss Universe 1952.
-

1927 — The Bird of Paradise, a U.S. Army Air Corps Fokker tri-motor, completes the first transpacific flight, from the mainland United States to Hawaii.

- 2007 — Apple Inc. releases its first mobile phone, the iPhone.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 181 of the year, 184 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Erentrude; Christian feast day: St. Paul the Apostle (solo feast day); Christian feast day: St. Mary of Jerusalem, mother of Apostle Mark the Evangelist first Bishop of Alexandria and Byblos; Christian feast day: St. Martial. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1964 — Mark Waters, American director and producer
- 1937 — Larry Henley, American singer-songwriter (died 2014)
- 1954 — Stephen Barlow, English organist, composer, and conductor
- 1984 — Fantasia Barrino, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1936 — Nancy Dussault, American actress and singer
- 1952 — David Garrison, American actor and singer
- 1933 — M. J. K. Smith, English cricketer and rugby player
- 1943 — Florence Ballard, American pop/soul singer (died 1976)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1994 — An Airbus A330-300 crashes during a test flight at Toulouse–Blagnac Airport, killing all seven people on board.
- 1985 — Thirty-nine American hostages from the hijacked TWA Flight 847 are freed in Beirut after being held for 17 days.
- 1986 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules in *Bowers v. Hardwick* that states can outlaw homosexual acts between consenting adults.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2023 — A Tajik citizen with ISIS connections, wanted in Tajikistan for murder and kidnapping, kills two people at Chişinău International Airport in Moldova, after being denied entry to the country.
- 2009 — Yemenia Flight 626, an Airbus A310-300, crashes into the Indian Ocean near Comoros, killing 152 of the 153 people on board. A 14-year-old girl named Bahia Bakari survives the crash.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)